



Reimagining the dating mechanism with a new feature

Market Snapshot

MAU	Paying users	Liquidity time	ARPPU
80 – 100 M	5% – 15%	24-72hrs for males	18\$

Business model



messaging
and matching



Omegle style
matching



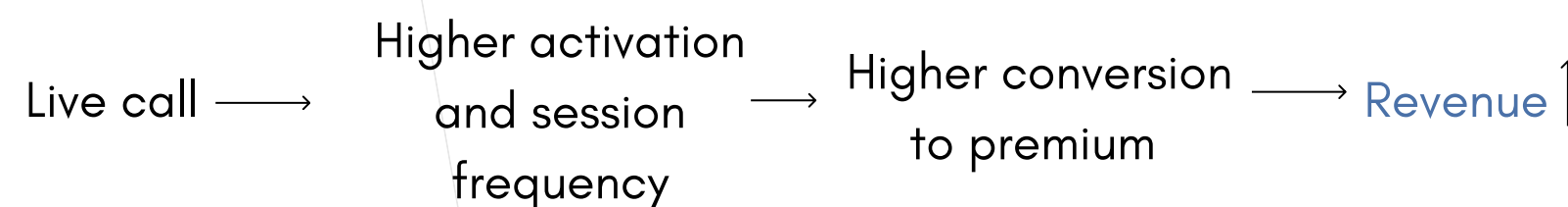
Premium/Freemium

How does the Sonder tab align with Hinge's Existing business

We already have profile-based matching (Bumble App), calling infrastructure (Video/Voice), and a subscription paywall. Sonder reuses all three, it's a new discovery surface built entirely on infrastructure Bumble already owns.

Why should these businesses care?

Bumble is in a retention and differentiation crisis, not a growth stage — paying users fell 16% YoY and revenue fell ~9% YoY (Q3 2025 vs Q3 2024). It needs a new engagement lever, not just marginal algorithm tweaks.



$$\text{Revenue} = \text{Avg Revenue Per User (ARPU)} * \text{\#Users}$$
$$\text{ARPU} = \text{Avg order value/user} * \text{Avg frequency of orders}$$

Product Discovery

Goal: Let users judge real chemistry through voice/video before investing days into texting a stranger who may not be who they seem.

What is “real chemistry”?

"Everything on my summary and matches these days is a full risk. I've decided I'll write for a week to someone who turns out to have a totally different personality than their profile suggested."

- **Harsh**, 22 years, Goa

Perception: Generally understood as: hearing someone's tone, humor, and reactions live the things a profile and 6 texts can't convey. It's the digital version of the "does this feel real" gut-check people rely on in person

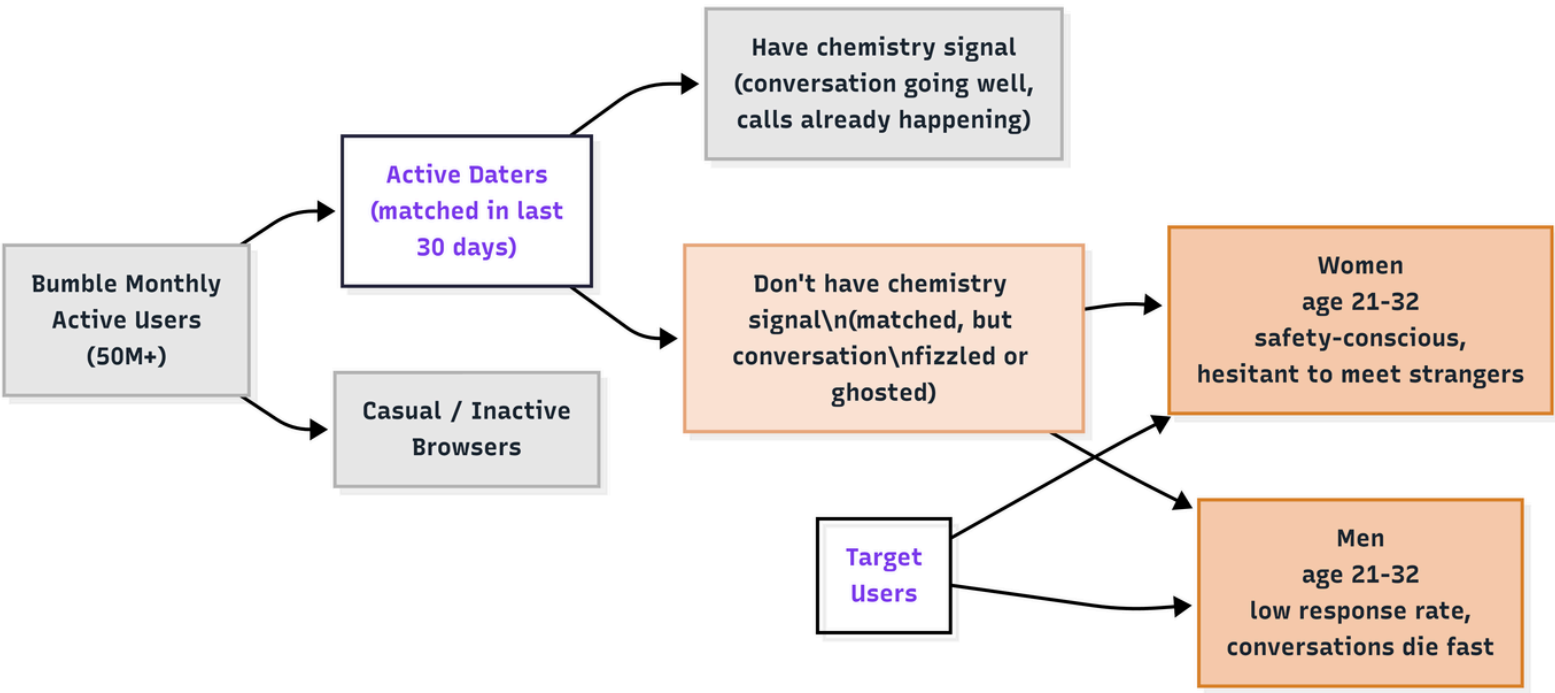
Why does this matter?

Text-based matching creates a verification and effort gap — users sink days into conversation before learning whether there's any real chemistry, and separately, before confirming the person is even who their profile claims. Both problems compound into "dating app fatigue," the single most cited reason for app abandonment across the category.

Actors in the System

- Callers — verified users opting into **Sonder** for faster discovery
- Matching Algorithm — **queues** and **pairs** users by stated interests/preferences
- Safety & Verification Layer — ID check + pre-call AI scan + in-call monitoring
- Platform — hosts identity, matching, calling, and payment infrastructure

Know our Users!



note:Note: Tier percentages are illustrative estimates based on category-wide dating app behavior patterns, not Company-specific data – validate with a targeted survey or pilot cohort before using in an investor-facing deck.

How big is the market?

50M MAU x 60% active daters x 45% experienced fizzled matches x 35% willing to try a new discovery mode ≈ 4.7M users

What are their problems?

- **78%** : Users who report feeling emotionally, mentally, or physically exhausted by dating apps at least sometimes (Forbes Health/OnePoll, 2024)
- **71% of men / 47% of women** : Frequently encounter fake or misleading profiles on dating apps (YouGov/Statista, 2023)
- **45%** : Admit to having ghosted (abandoned) a match themselves after a conversation stalled (DatingAdvice.com survey compilation)

Consolidated Problems

- No fast way to verify authenticity or "real vibe"
- Text-based discovery is high-effort and slow
- Existing calling are locked an committed match, too late to help

CURRENT	DESCRIPTION	MISSING
Bumble/Tinder	Video call <i>after</i> match	No discovery-stage calling
Hinge	Intentional prompts	Removed video calling entirely
Omegle (dead, 2023)	Random video chat	No matching algorithm, 0 safety

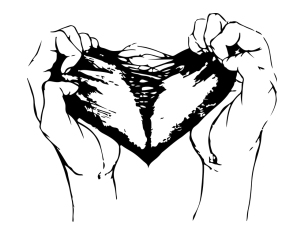


User Persona

26 yrs | Marketing Manager | Bangalore
New to the city, dating cautiously after a bad experience
Screens every profile carefully before replying,

Pain-Points
Struggles to tell if a profile is even real before engaging
Feels on-guard by default when talking to new matches

Needs
A way to verify someone is real before investing time
A lower-risk way to screen out bad actors earlier



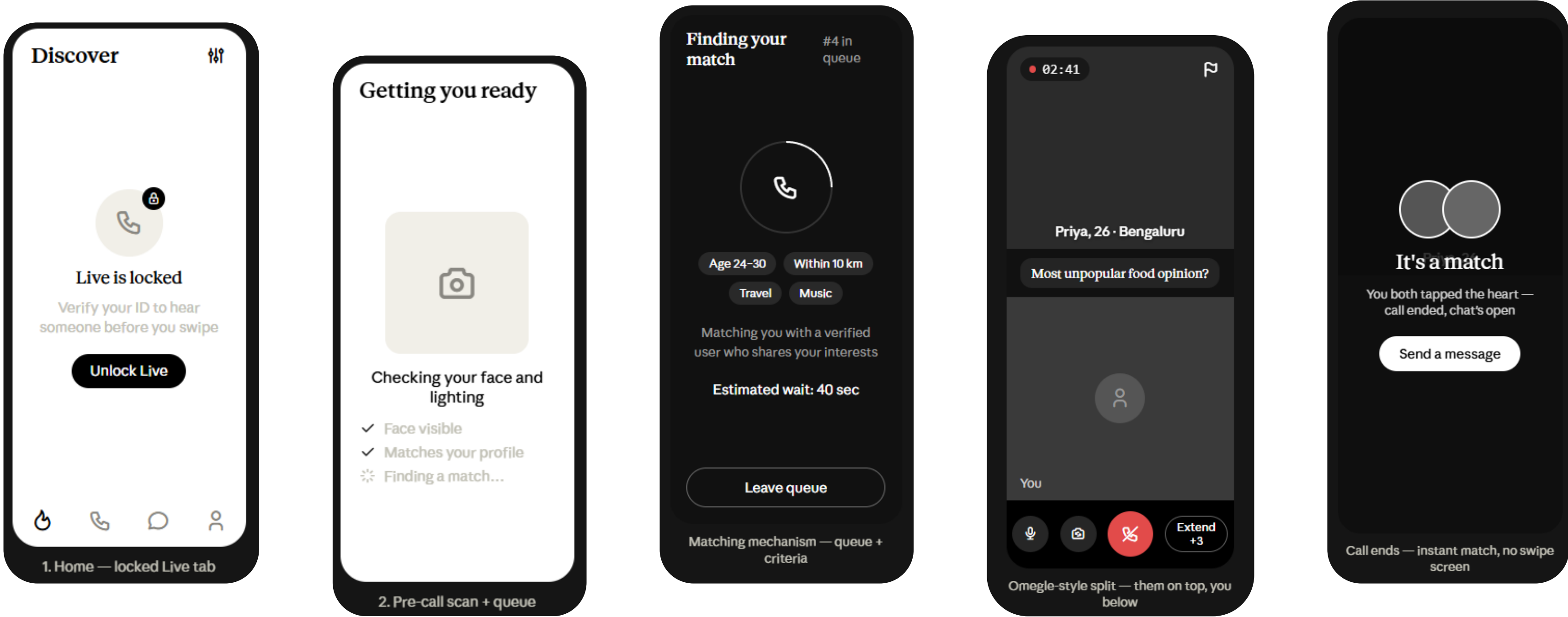
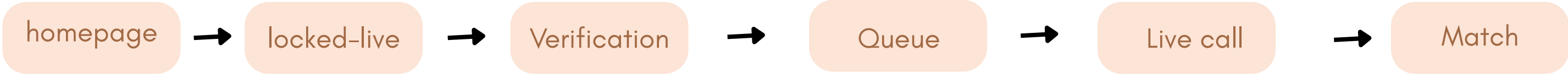
27 yrs | Investment Banker | Mumbai
Recently out of a long relationship | Swipes during commute
Sends plenty of opening messages, rarely gets a reply

Pain-Points
Feels like he's shouting into a void , most swipes go nowhere
Rarely gets a reply even when he does match

Needs
A way to show personality beyond a static profile/opening text
A way to feel less exposed to constant rejection

User Persona

How does our product look like? User side experience



"Lock badge creates FOMO before users even open the tab"
"One-line CTA, no explanation needed — curiosity does the work"

- "Camera check runs silently in the background"*
- "Checklist builds trust before the call even starts"*

Additional features that aren't mentioned here

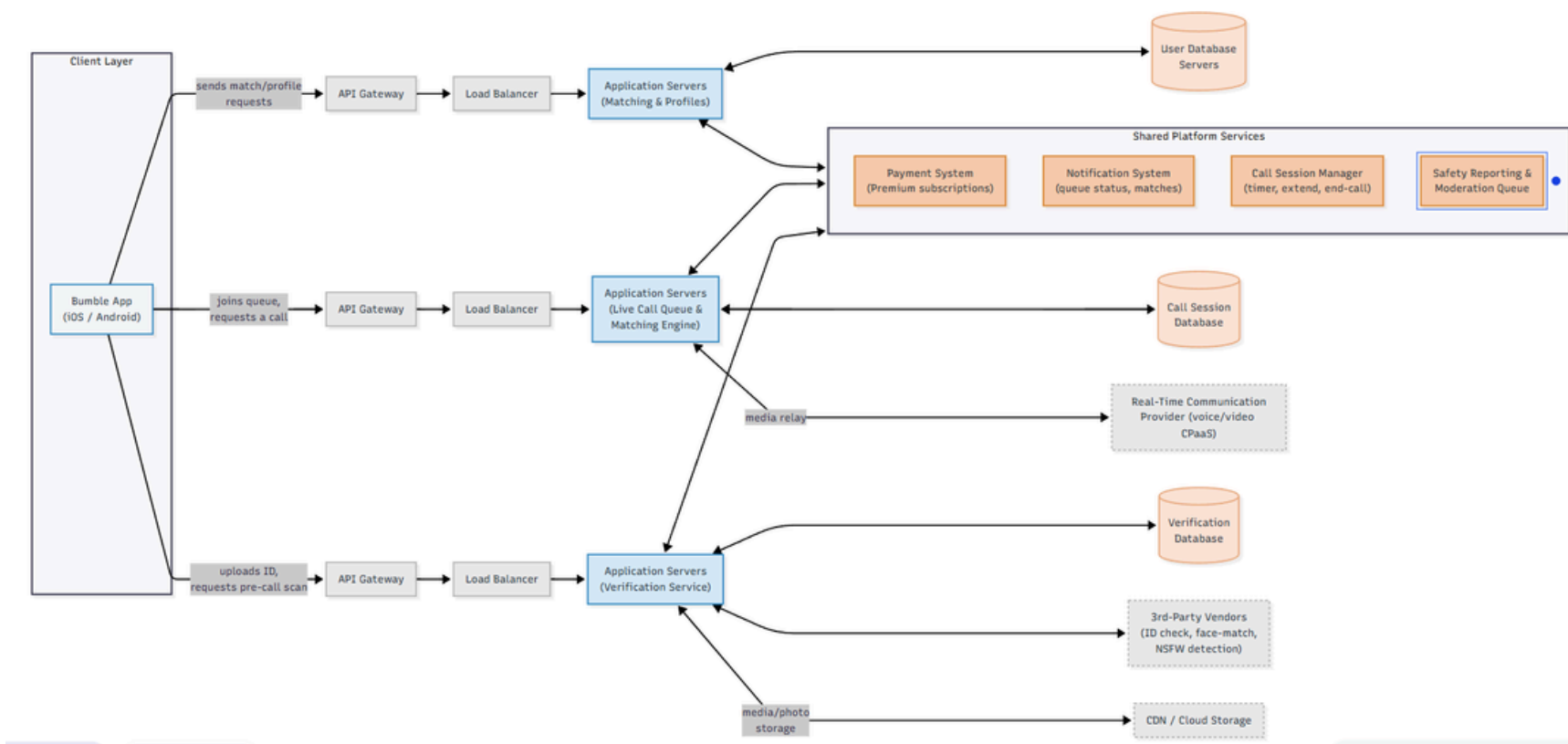
- Customer support to raise concerns
- Dedicated place to see all active subscriptions
- Manage subscriptions (Cancel- in MVP, Pause - Post MVP, Skip - Post MVP)

Check User App Prototype

What are the risks & how do we deal with them?

RISK	MITIGATION
Cold start — empty queue at odd hours	Launch single-metro; schedule "Live Hours" events to concentrate demand
Call anxiety limits adoption	Voice-only in v1 (not video); 3-min timer keeps commitment low
Safety incident during a call	3-layer system: ID verification + pre-call AI scan + in-call monitoring/report
Gender imbalance in queue	Priority queue for women; show live queue stats transparently
Feature cannibalizes Traditional Tab engagement	Frame as an alternate discovery mode, not a replacement — Traditional Tab remains default

System Design



What each piece does?

Matching & Profiles service	Verification Service	RTC Provider
Live Call Queue & Matching Engine	Shared Platform Services	

What are the second order effects of this product?

- Cannibalization risk:** Could reduce time spent in the Traditional Tab if users self-select into Live only — monitor total session time, not just Call Tab adoption,
- New user base:** Could attract call-anxious-but-safety-conscious users who previously avoided dating apps altogether, expanding Bumble's addressable market
- Category shift:** If successful, could push Hinge/Tinder to re-enter live-call discovery, turning this into a new expected feature category-wide first

What is the true problem?

User Side

People away from home lack access to authentic, homely, native cuisine they used to have at home. Other options, often oily and spicy, get repetitive in taste and require daily effort to procure

Home-chef Side

Passionate home cooks, often women who can not go out of home and work, looking to earn, struggle to find regular customers due to lack of reach, business acumen, ingredients & equipment, logistical support.

How do we know its a real problem?

Data for interstate migration in India shows- Of 11 Cr people who migrated from the age 15 to 32 years, nearly 10% shifted in search for employment & 3.5% for Education. This takes people away from native home-cooked meal. Who had home cooked were more satisfied with meal with an upside to good health.

Labor Force Participation Rate of women in India is just 21%. Inconvenience of leaving family responsibilities behind is one of the major reasons. Their cooking skills are underappreciated, yet exceptional but no means to leverage. They are at utmost need of building identity and financial upliftment.

Why should we solve this problem NOW?

With COVID effects decreasing, school and office reopening are boosting migration and home-cooked meal demand & shifted people’s behaviour significantly towards health. Drawing parallels from health insurance industry-



What value will be generated by solving this problem?

For the Users

Users will be assured that they are eating good quality, healthy and balanced meal of their native choice and palate, daily at their doorstep with minimum time and effort at reasonable minimal cost.

Their meals would be a medium to keep them close to their root/culture, something that keeps that close to home.

For the Home-chefs

Target women will be able to earn extra, be independent and build own identity.

$$\text{Avg meal slots/day} \times (\text{Avg Order Value} - \text{Avg Cost incurred/meal}) \times \text{avg \#days served/month} - \% \text{Commission}$$
$$= 10 \times (\text{₹}150 - \text{₹}50) \times 28 - (10\%) = \text{₹}25,200/\text{month}$$

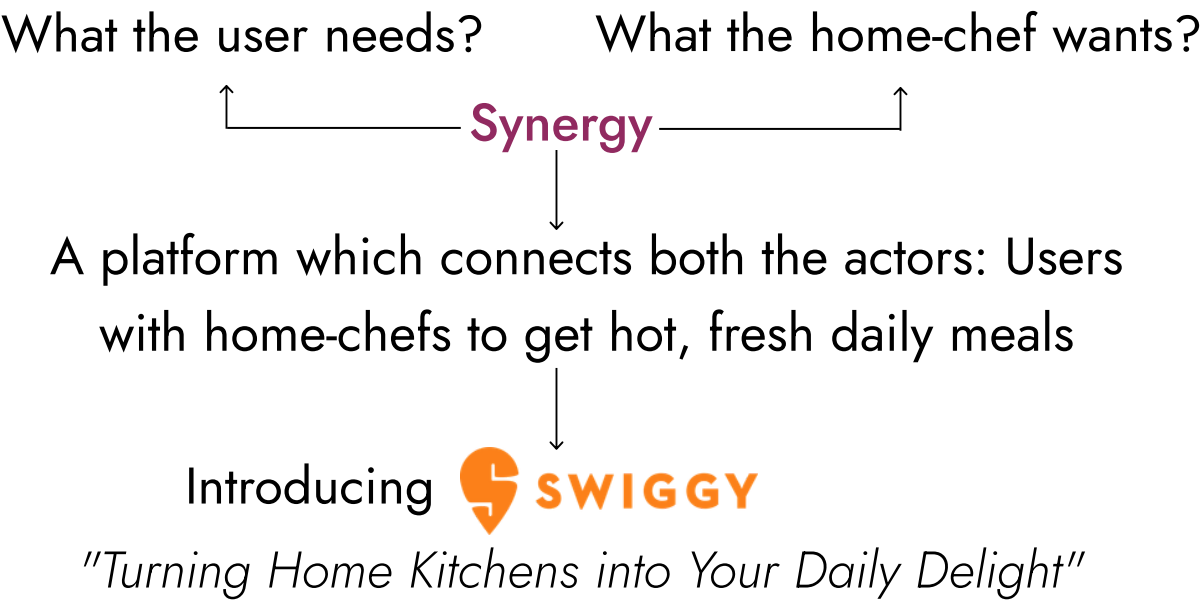
~₹25,000/- month earning on an average
This shows a significant earnings for an Indian women for self and to support her family.

For the Business

The target demand market size is significantly large. Once implemented fully, *a way to be a market leader in this home-cooked meal with annual revenue boost of:*

Potential Population target users being addressed x Avg value/meal x avg frequency of meals x %commission x market share x avg \#days served/yr = 10Mn x ₹100 x 1.2 x 5% x 60% x 300 days = ₹1080 Cr. ~ \$130 M

How do we plan to solve this problem?



What does it offer to the users?

- ✓ Fresh meals straight from the home-chef’s kitchen
- ✓ Quick delivery of meals on preferred time & place
- ✓ Promise of top quality ingredients & hygiene
- ✓ Multi-state cuisines to suit your taste like home
- ✓ Subscriptions for effortless easy meal experience
- ✓ Food comes hot & safe with Swiggy’s packaging

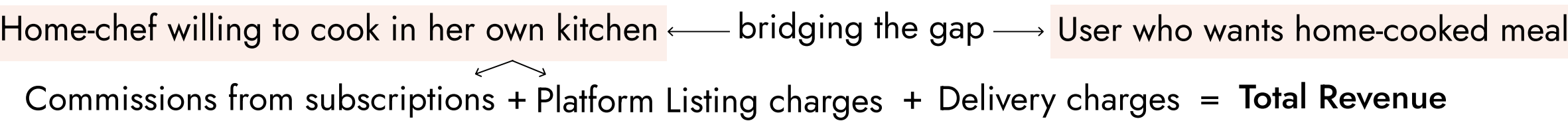
What does it offer to the home-chefs?

- ✓ Generates side income to empower them
- ✓ Much needed appreciation for their skills
- ✓ Gives them a chance to create their own identity

Riskiest hypothesis

- 1 We will get enough supply side actors, who are ready to cook meals for others
- 2 The quality and taste of the meals will be consistent with the standards and users will trust home-chefs

How does it work & How do we make money?



How are we prioritising what to build in the MVP ? [R=Reach, I=Impact, C=Confidence, E=Effort]

Problem	Solution Features	R	I	C	E	Priority <u>(Score)</u>
Lack of Quality & Hygiene	• Chef Rank: Gauged by ratings & reviews, driving chefs to uphold quality	H	H	H	L	MVP
	• Partner with Instamart to deliver quality monthly groceries & cooking equipments to our home chefs	H	H	H	M	MVP
	• Regular audits of the chef’s kitchen + stringent guidelines on oil, spices levels	H	H	M	H	MVP
Lack of Native Cuisine	• Chef Variety: Onboard chefs who can cook multi-state cuisines	H	M	M	H	MVP
	• Chef Up skill: Portal for enhancing chefs’ skills with multi-state, healthy recipe videos	M	M	H	M	Post- MVP
	• Chef community: Peer to peer learning space for learning new recipes & methods	H	H	M	H	Post- MVP
Taste is repetitive	• What to cook? Suggest non-repeating menus and new recipes to the chefs on a daily basis	M	H	H	L	MVP
	• Chef rotation: Recommend new chefs to the user based on their past choices & future preferences of cuisines	H	H	M	H	Post- MVP
	• Request a dish: Users can request a dish to the home-chef & also send the recipe	L	M	H	L	Post- MVP
Meal is not hot/fresh	• Hyperlocal delivery of home-cooked meals	H	H	H	M	MVP
	• Provide our in-house quality packaging to home-chefs	H	H	H	L	MVP
	• Alert home chef to start prep based on order volume	M	M	H	H	MVP